



Questionnaire:

Journey Beyond – SeaLink Rottneest

Journey Beyond – Kelsian Tourism Portfolio

MN – 50011 & MN – 85015

Deadline to respond: 10 July 2026

The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (**ACCC**) is currently assessing Experience Australia Group Pty Ltd's (**EAG**) proposed acquisitions of certain tourism businesses and assets from Kelsian Group Limited and its subsidiaries (**Kelsian**).

EAG primarily operates under the brand name "Journey Beyond" in Australia.

EAG is proposing to acquire:

- a range of tourism businesses and assets across the East Coast of Australia, including ferries, resorts and tour services (the **Kelsian Tourism Portfolio**), which includes
- the SeaLink Rottneest Island ferries business in Western Australia (**SeaLink Rottneest**), operated by Vyscot Pty Ltd (**Vyscot**).

The Kelsian Tourism Portfolio comprises:

- **Adelaide Sightseeing Tours:** tour services in the Adelaide region
- **Murray Princess Cruise:** cruise experiences along the Murray River, South Australia
- **Tasmania Ferries:** ferry services between Bruny Island and Tasmania mainland
- **Sydney Harbour Cruises and Ferries:** harbour cruise and ferry services in Sydney
- **K'gari Resorts, Tours and Ferries:** resort accommodation, tour and ferry services on K'gari (Fraser Island)
- **Northern Territory Ferries:** ferry and boat services in the Northern Territory
- **Swan River Cruises:** cruise and charter services operating from the Barrack Street Jetty in Perth

- **Swan Valley Tours:** river cruise and coach tour services from Perth to the Swan Valley
- **Bells Functions:** waterfront function and event space at the Barrack Street Jetty in Perth
- **SeaLink Rottnest:** the passenger ferry service from Perth and Fremantle to Rottnest Island

The acquisition of the Kelsian Tourism Portfolio, except for SeaLink Rottnest, was notified to the ACCC on 1 July 2026. See the Acquisition Register [here](#).

The acquisition of SeaLink Rottnest is the subject of a separate notification to the ACCC, also notified on 1 July 2026. See the Acquisition Register [here](#).

Both acquisitions are referred to in this questionnaire as the **Acquisitions**.

The ACCC is assessing the impact of the Acquisitions on competition and is seeking your views. The ACCC invites you to provide submissions or information in response to the questions below by 10 July 2026 via email to mergers@accc.gov.au with the title *Submission re: Journey Beyond Acquisitions*. The ACCC must complete its assessment within strict statutory timelines which also impacts the time available for consultation.

If you would prefer to speak to a member of the ACCC case team, please email mergers@accc.gov.au with the title *Request for call re: Journey Beyond – Acquisitions*. Someone from the case team will contact you to find a suitable time for a call.

Please note that:

- This request is made in accordance with section 51ABZZD(2)(a) and (c) of the *Competition and Consumer Act 2010* (Cth) (the **Act**). This means that while the ACCC may take into account submissions or information received after the due date, it is not required to do so.
- In responding to the questions below or when providing a submission, please highlight and/or mark any confidential information and indicate why the information is confidential (as brief reasons in footnotes in your response or submission, or in a separate document such as the ACCC's [confidentiality claims template](#)). The standard terms on which the ACCC accepts confidential information are outlined at the end of this document.

Questions

1. Provide a brief description of your business or organisation, including any commercial relationship with Journey Beyond and/or Kelsian.

2. Outline any concerns regarding the impact of the Acquisitions on competition.

East Coast and Northern Territory Tourism Services

3. How closely do Journey Beyond and Kelsian compete for the supply of tourism experiences and services in the following areas:

- a. Adelaide, SA;
- b. Murray River region, SA;
- c. Bruny Island, TAS
- d. Sydney, NSW;
- e. K'gari or the Whitsundays, QLD;
- f. Darwin, NT.

4. If you are a provider of tour services at K'gari/Fraser Island, which ferry service operators do you use and why.

Rottnest Island ferry services

5. How closely do Journey Beyond and Kelsian compete for the supply of ferry services from Perth and/or Fremantle to Rottnest Island?

6. Who are alternative suppliers of ferry services from Perth and/or Fremantle to Rottnest Island?

7. To what extent is Rottnest Fast Ferries an alternative?

8. Provide details of how suppliers of ferry services from Perth and/or Fremantle to Rottnest Island compete (e.g. pricing, frequency of services, service quality, location, bundled tour offerings)?

9. What factors do customers consider most important when choosing a ferry operator?

10. What are the barriers to entry and/or expansion for the supply of ferry services from Perth and/or Fremantle?

In your response, you may wish to refer to costs (such as capital expenditure for new vessels), necessary inputs (such as access to berth and availability of time slots), and any other barriers.

11. How difficult would it be for a new operator to commence supplying ferry services to Rottnest Island?

12. Please provide any additional information or comments that you consider relevant to the ACCC's assessment of the Acquisitions, including any potential effects on businesses operating on Rottnest Island.

Confidentiality of responses

During the ACCC's assessment of a notified acquisition, the ACCC may receive information that is properly regarded as being confidential, and which is provided to the ACCC in confidence. The ACCC is committed to treating this information responsibly and in accordance with the law. The ACCC understands the importance of confidentiality to parties involved in a notified acquisition, as well as to third parties that provide information to the ACCC.

The standard terms on which the ACCC accepts confidential information are:

- there is no restriction on the internal use, including future use, that the ACCC may make of the confidential information consistent with the ACCC's statutory functions
- confidential information may be disclosed to the ACCC's external advisors and consultants on condition that each such advisor or consultant will be informed of the obligation to treat the information as confidential, and
- the ACCC may disclose the confidential information to other third parties if compelled by law or in accordance with section 155AAA of the Act. This includes disclosures made in the performance of official duties or functions, which include transparency requirements which are part of the merger control regime.

For further information on confidentiality, see the ACCC's [interim merger process guidelines](#).